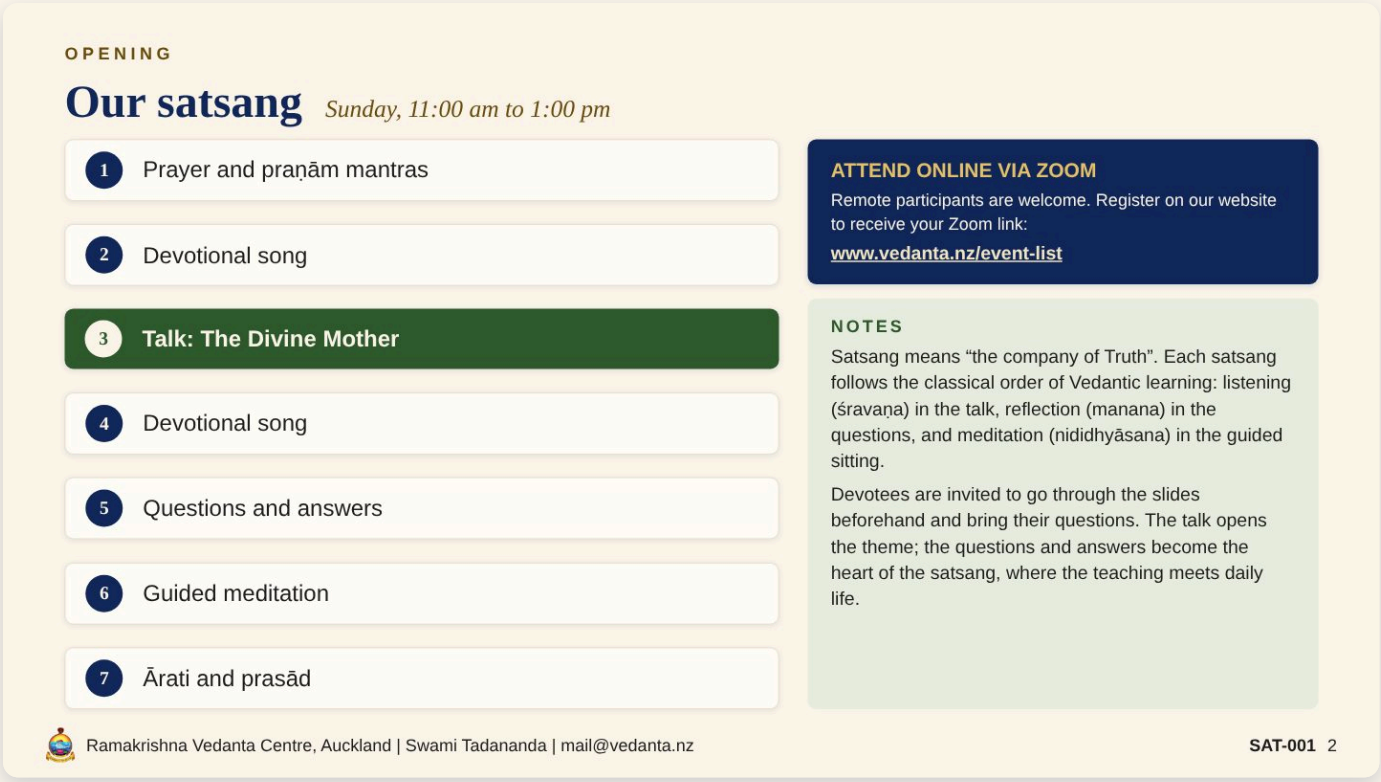


The Divine Mother

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

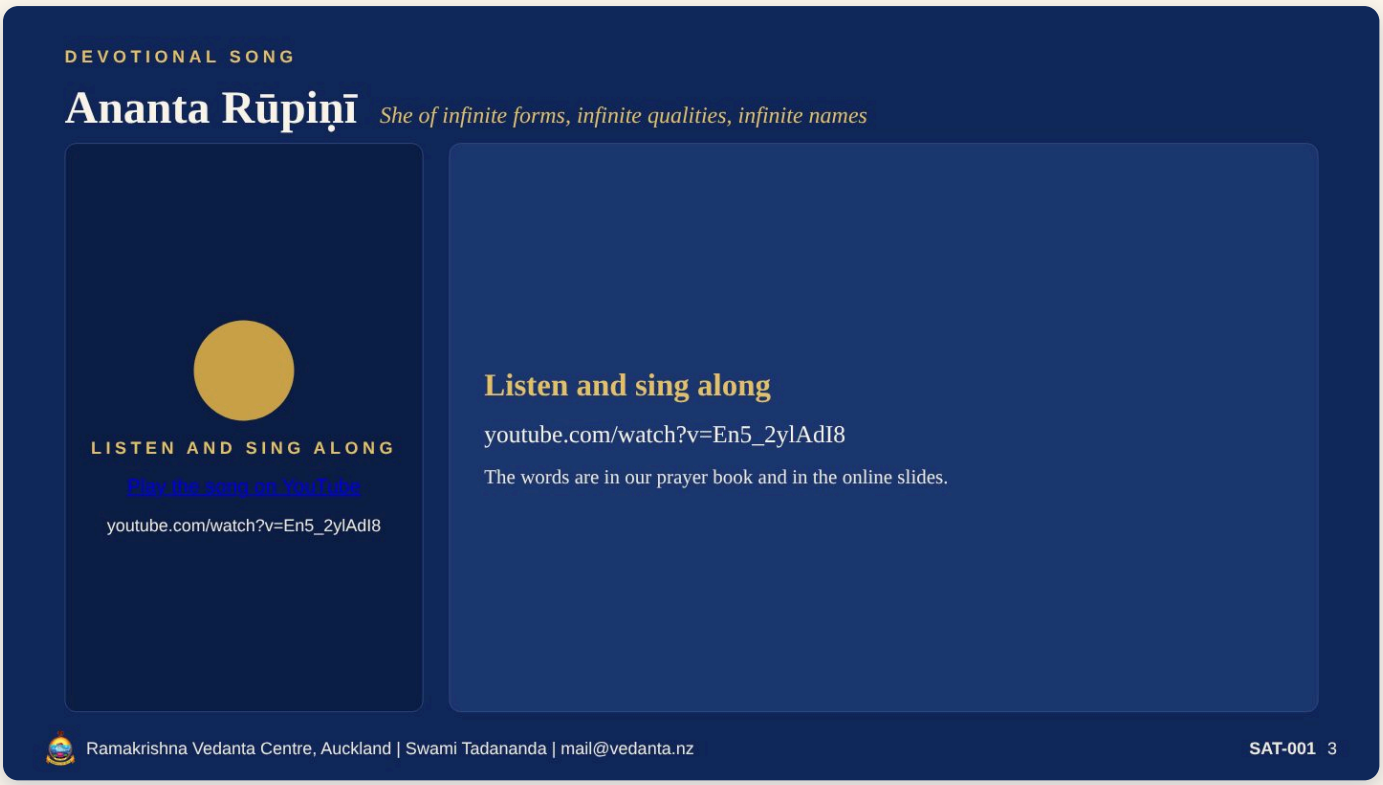
Welcome everyone, in the room and on Zoom. In the Durgā Pūjā we worship the Divine Mother in the image. Here we ask where else she lives: as the power behind the whole universe, and as the power within our own body, breath, mind, intellect and sense of I. We will close with practices to recognise her and receive her grace in every action.



Our satsang

SWAMIJI’S NOTES

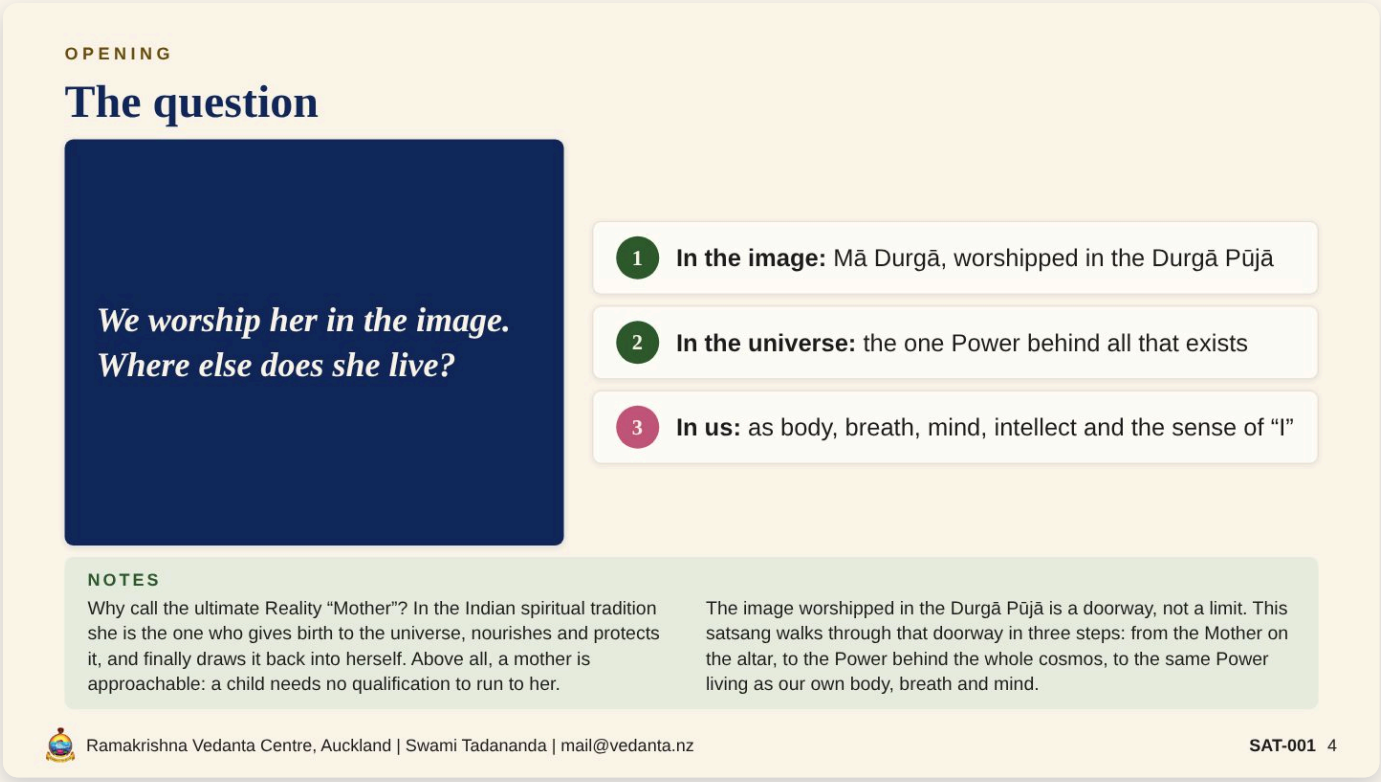
The general order of every satsang, 11:00 am to 1:00 pm, kept flexible with no fixed times. The Yā Devī chant is sung within the talk. The talk is about one hour and moves through five parts: the Mother one with Brahman; she has become all; she within us; the Ramakrishna tradition’s living worship; and practices for realising her grace.



Ananta Rūpiṇī

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

Devotional song: Ananta Rūpiṇī. Recording: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=En5_2ylAdI8 . The three epithets set the theme of the satsang: the Mother has infinite forms (the universe), infinite qualities (her powers within us) and infinite names (the many ways we call on her).



The question

SWAMIJI’S NOTES

Begin with the Durgā Pūjā. Ask: we worship her in the image, but where else does she live? The answer is the arc of the talk: in the image, in the universe, and in us. For newcomers, explain why the Indian spiritual tradition calls the ultimate Reality Mother: she creates, sustains and dissolves, and above all she is approachable. A child does not need qualifications to go to its mother.

ONE WITH BRAHMAN

Fire and its power to burn

“Brahman and Śakti are identical. If you accept the one, you must accept the other. It is like fire and its power to burn.”

Sri Ramakrishna, The Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna



At rest

Brahman

When he thought of the Supreme as inactive, neither creating, preserving nor destroying, Sri Ramakrishna called it Brahman.

In action

Śakti, the Mother

When he thought of it as active, creating, preserving and destroying, he called it Śakti: the same Reality, now as Power.

NOTES

Brahman at rest, the Mother in motion: one Reality. Sri Ramakrishna used simple images: fire and its power to burn, milk and its whiteness, a gem and its lustre. We cannot think of one without the other. He also spoke of a snake, coiled and still, and the same snake moving. Advaita Vedanta calls the one Reality Brahman; the worshipper calls it Śakti, the Mother. Kashmir Śaivism says the same: Śiva and Śakti, light and its pulse (spanda), are one.

Fire and its power to burn

SWAMIJI’S NOTES

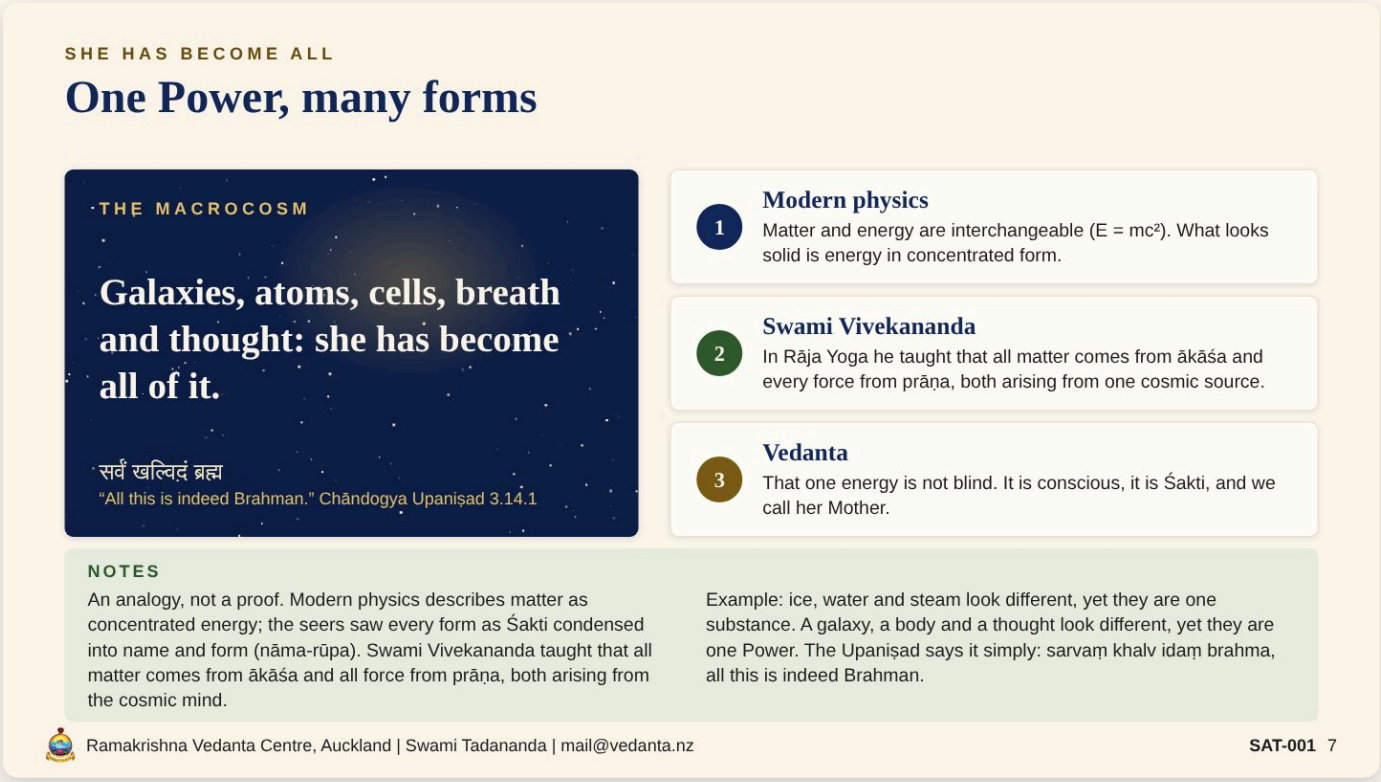
The foundation of the talk. The Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna (tr. Swami Nikhilananda): “When I think of the Supreme Being as inactive, neither creating nor preserving nor destroying, I call Him Brahman or Purusha, the Impersonal God. When I think of Him as active, creating, preserving and destroying, I call Him Sakti or Maya or Prakriti, the Personal God. But the distinction between them does not mean a difference. Clicks reveal: at rest, in action, then the banner.



“I am the Queen”: the Devī Sūkta

SWAMIJI’S NOTES

The Devī Sūkta (Ṛg Veda 10.125), eight verses, also called the Vāk Sūkta. The seer Vāk Āmbhṛṇī speaks as the Goddess. Verse 1: she moves with all the groups of gods. Verse 3: she is the sovereign queen (rāṣṭrī), gatherer of wealth, the knowing one (cikituṣī). Verse 8: she breathes forth like the wind, beginning (giving shape to) all the worlds. It is traditionally recited before the Chaṇḍī.



One Power, many forms

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

The macrocosm. The starfield on the left twinkles slowly. Swami Vivekananda, Rāja Yoga, chapter on Prāṇa: the whole universe is made of two materials, ākāśa (the all-pervading existence from which all matter comes) and prāṇa (the infinite power from which all force comes), both of which arise from Mahat, the cosmic mind. Present the physics as an analogy that helps us picture the teaching, not as a proof. Chāndogya Upaniṣad 3.14.1: sarvaṃ khalv idaṃ brahma.

SHE HAS BECOME ALL

Three moods of the one Mother

1

Mahākālī

महाकाली

The story: Madhu and Kaiṭabha, born while Viṣṇu sleeps

Within us: inertia, dullness, spiritual sleep (tamas)

Her grace: she wakes us up

2

Mahālakṣmī

महालक्ष्मी

The story: Mahiṣāsura, the buffalo demon who keeps changing shape

Within us: restless desire, anger and ego (rajas)

Her grace: strength to conquer ourselves

3

Mahāsarasvatī

महासरस्वती

The story: Śumbha and Niśumbha, the proud brothers

Within us: subtle pride, the sense of "I" and "mine"

Her grace: wisdom that dissolves duality

The battle of the Chaṇḍī is fought within us, and the Mother fights it for us.

NOTES

The Devī Māhātmya (Chaṇḍī), seven hundred verses from the Mārkaṇḍeya Purāṇa, tells three stories, each presided over by one aspect of the Mother: Mahākālī, Mahālakṣmī and Mahāsarasvatī. It is recited during Durgā Pūjā and Navarātri.

A common inner reading sees the demons as tendencies of the mind, matching the three guṇas: inertia, restlessness and subtle pride. The outer festival pictures an inner victory. We cannot win it by effort alone: we call on her, and she fights for us.

Three moods of the one Mother

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

Three episodes of the Chaṇḍī. First (chapter 1), presided over by Mahākālī: the demons Madhu and Kaiṭabha arise while Viṣṇu sleeps; the Devī as Yoganidrā withdraws from him so he wakes. Inner meaning: tamas, the sleep of the spirit; her grace awakens us. Middle (chapters 2 to 4), Mahālakṣmī: Mahiṣāsura keeps changing form, like desire and anger. Inner meaning: rajas. Last (chapters 5 to 13), Mahāsarasvatī: Śumbha and Niśumbha, subtle pride and the sense of separateness. Inner meaning: the subtle ego that even good people carry. Connect to the Durgā Pūjā: the image of victory is a picture of what she does within us.

KASHMIR ŚAIVISM

Citi: the free Power behind all

Sūtra 1

चितिः स्वतन्त्रा विश्वसिद्धिहेतुः ॥ १ ॥

citiḥ svatantrā viśva-siddhi-hetuḥ

“Consciousness, perfectly free, is the cause of the whole universe.”

Citi is feminine: the Mother as pure, self-aware Power. She needs nothing outside herself to create.

Sūtra 2

स्वेच्छया स्वभित्तौ विश्वमुन्मीलयति ॥ २ ॥

svecchayā svabhittau viśvam unmīlayati

“By her own will, on her own screen, she unfolds the universe.”

No outside material and no outside canvas: like a dream within the dreamer, the world appears within her.

She is both the painter and the canvas.

NOTES

The Pratyabhijñāhṛdayam (“The Heart of Recognition”) is a short text of twenty sūtras by Kṣemarāja, a great teacher of Kashmir Śaivism. Its first sūtra names Citi, free Consciousness, as the one cause of the universe. The word is feminine: Citi is the Mother.

Sūtra 2 adds that she needs no outside material: she unfolds the world by her own will, on her own screen. In a dream, the dreamer's mind is stage, actors and scenery at once. This echoes Sri Ramakrishna: Brahman and Śakti are one, like fire and its power to burn.

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Citi: the free Power behind all

SWAMIJI’S NOTES

Kashmir Śaivism gives the Mother a precise philosophical voice. Sūtra 1: Citi, Consciousness that is free (svatantrā), is the cause (hetu) of the accomplishment (siddhi) of the universe: its appearance, maintenance and dissolution. Notice the word is feminine. Sūtra 2: she unfolds (unmīlayati, as an eye opens) the universe by her own will (svecchayā) on her own screen (svabhittau). No outside clay, no outside canvas. Example for newcomers: in a dream, the dreamer’s own mind is the stage, the actors and the scenery. Link to Sri Ramakrishna: Brahman and Śakti are inseparable, like fire and its power to burn.

KASHMIR ŚAIVISM

She contracts to become us

Sūtra 3

तन्नाना अनुरूपग्राह्यग्राहकभेदात्

tan nānā anurūpa-grāhya-grāhaka-bhedāt

"The universe is many because she divides into matching knowers and known."

Seer and seen arise together, like two hands of one body.

Sūtra 4

चितिसंकोचात्मा चेतनोऽपि संकुचितविश्वमयः

citi-saṅkocātmā cetano 'pi saṅkucita-viśvamayaḥ

"Even the individual, being Consciousness contracted, holds the universe in contracted form."

Each of us is the whole of her, compressed: a bubble holding the ocean's nature.

Sūtra 5

चितिरेव चेतनपदादवरूढा चेत्यसंकोचिनी चित्तम्

citir eva cetana-padād avarūḍhā cetya-saṅkocinī cittam

"Citi herself, descending from pure awareness and narrowing to what she perceives, becomes the mind."

Our mind is the Mother in disguise.

From Citi to citta, and back: sādhanā expands the mind into her again.

NOTES

Sūtra 3: one Consciousness appears as many, because she divides herself into matching knowers and known things. Sūtra 4: each individual is Citi contracted, holding the whole universe in seed form, as a seed holds the tree.

Sūtra 5 completes the descent: Citi herself, narrowing to what she perceives, becomes citta, the mind. So the mind is not an enemy but the Mother in a narrowed form. Sādhanā is the return journey, and the five sheaths show its stages.

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She contracts to become us

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

Sūtra 3: the universe is manifold (nānā) because of the division into corresponding objects (grāhya) and subjects (grāhaka). Every level of experience has its own knower and its own known. Sūtra 4: the individual experiencer (cetana) is Citi contracted (saṅkoca), and holds the whole universe in contracted form, as a seed holds the tree. Sūtra 5: Citi herself, descending (avarūḍhā) from the plane of pure awareness, contracting in accordance with the objects she perceives (cetya-saṅkocinī), becomes citta, the mind. So the mind is not an enemy to be fought but the Mother in a narrowed form. Sādhanā is the reverse journey: the mind expands back into Citi. This leads directly into the five sheaths, read from the outside in.

SRI RAMAKRISHNA'S TEACHING

Her two powers: Vidyā Māyā and Avidyā Māyā

अविद्या माया Avidyā Māyā

The power that binds: it pulls us outward

- Attachment to sense pleasures and possessions
- The sense of "I and mine"
- Forgetting who we really are
- Like a mist, it hides the sun without harming it

विद्या माया Vidyā Māyā

The power that frees: it leads us inward

- Discrimination (viveka) and dispassion
- Devotion, compassion and the company of the holy
- Longing for God, prayer and service
- Like a ladder, it carries us up to the roof

Both are her powers. The same Mother who binds is the Mother who sets free.

NOTES

Sri Ramakrishna taught that Māyā, the Mother's power, has two faces. Avidyā Māyā deludes: it binds us through lust and greed, the restless pull of the senses, and the sense of "I and mine". Vidyā Māyā liberates: knowledge, devotion, dispassion, discrimination, compassion and holy company draw us towards God.

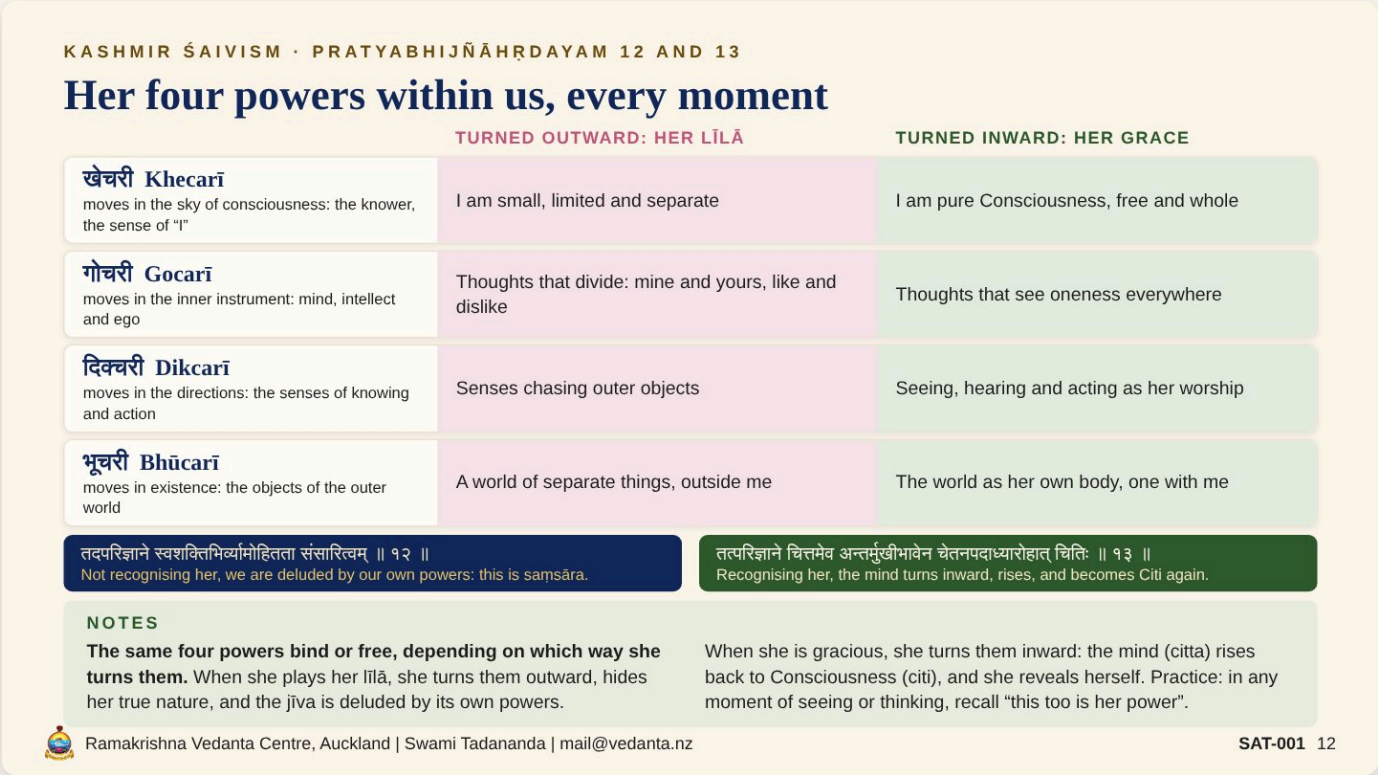
The Upaniṣad says the mind alone is the cause of bondage and liberation (mana eva manuṣyāṇāṃ kāraṇaṃ bandha-mokṣayoḥ). The same energy of the mind binds when it runs outward and frees when it turns inward. We take refuge in Vidyā Māyā, and the Mother herself then takes us beyond both.

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Her two powers: Vidyā Māyā and Avidyā Māyā

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

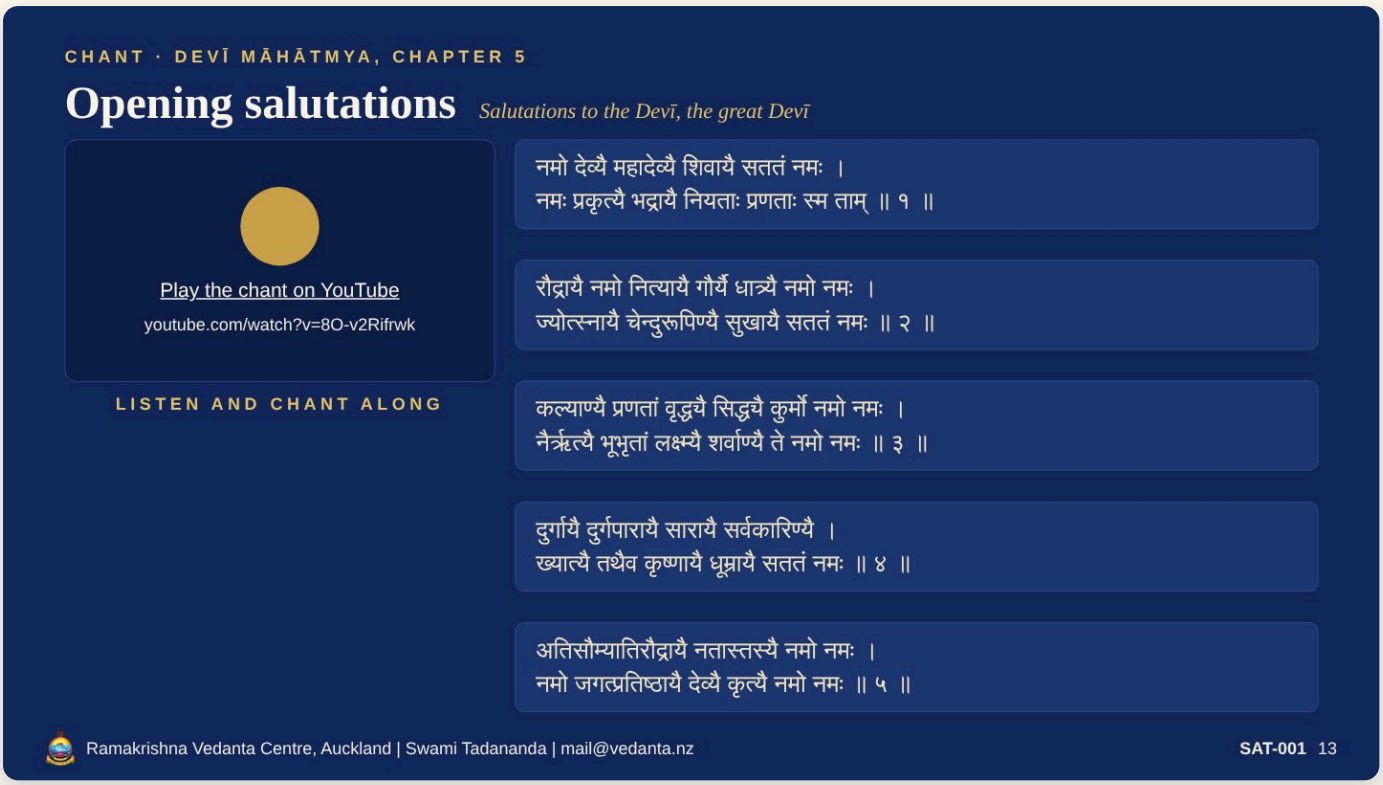
Sri Ramakrishna, in the Gospel, speaks of Māyā as having two aspects: avidyā-māyā (lust and greed, which bind) and vidyā-māyā (knowledge, devotion, renunciation, discrimination, compassion and the company of holy men, which lead to God). The ladder and the roof: the steps of vidyā help us climb, and on reaching the roof one sees that the steps are made of the same material as the roof. Please quote his exact words from your copy of the Gospel if you wish to read them. Amṛtabindu Upaniṣad 2: mana eva manuṣyāṇāṃ kāraṇaṃ bandha-mokṣayoḥ. For newcomers: Māyā is not a deceiving demon but the Mother's own creative power, which can hide or reveal.



Her four powers within us, every moment

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

Pratyabhijñāhṛdayam sūtra 12: tad-aparijñāne svaśaktibhir vyāmohitatā saṃsāritvam, when Citi is not recognised, being deluded by one's own powers is transmigratory existence. Kṣemarāja's commentary describes the group of powers (Vāmeśvarī) as Khecarī, Gocarī, Dikcarī and Bhūcarī: khe-carī moves in kha, the sky of consciousness, as the limited experiencer; go-carī in the inner organ (antaḥkaraṇa); dik-carī in the outer senses; bhū-carī in the objective world. In bondage they produce limited agency, differentiating thought, differentiating perception and separate objects; when the Self is recognised, the same powers express universal agency, unifying thought, unifying perception and the world as one's own body. Sūtra 13: tat-parijñāne cittam eva antarmukhī-bhāvena cetana-padādhyārohāt citiḥ, when Citi is recognised, the mind itself, by turning inward and ascending to the state of the knower, becomes Citi.



Opening salutations

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

Recording: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8O-v2Rifrwk . The hymn of the gods to the Devī from the Devī Māhātmya (Chaṇḍī), chapter 5. Verses 1 to 5 are salutations to her many forms: the great Goddess, Nature (prakṛti), the fierce and the gentle, Gaurī, the moonlight, Durgā who takes us across difficulties, and the foundation of the world. Then the Yā Devī verses follow on the next slide.



Yā Devī Sarva-bhūteṣu

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

The Yā Devī verses (Devī Māhātmya 5, verses 6 to 26 in this numbering), followed by the two closing verses. Each line salutes the Devī who dwells in all beings in a particular form; after each line the refrain is chanted: namas tasyai namas tasyai namas tasyai namo namaḥ. The forms: Viṣṇumāyā, consciousness, intelligence, sleep, hunger, shadow, power, thirst, forbearance, origin, modesty, peace, faith, beauty, prosperity, activity, memory, compassion, contentment, mother, and even delusion. Verse 27: she presides over the senses of all beings and pervades them. Verse 28: she pervades this whole world as Consciousness (citi).

SHE WITHIN US

Where you met her today

चेतना **Consciousness** The awareness behind your seeing, right now	बुद्धि **Intelligence** The clarity that solved today's problem	निद्रा **Sleep** The rest that restored you last night	क्षुधा **Hunger** She was there at breakfast
शक्ति **Power** The strength to get up and do your work	तृष्णा **Longing** Even desire is her energy, waiting to be turned to her	क्षान्ति **Patience** Forbearance in a queue, or with a difficult person	शान्ति **Peace** The quiet after a moment of prayer
श्रद्धा **Faith** Trust as you begin something new	स्मृति **Memory** A loved face, recalled in an instant	दया **Compassion** A kind word, given or received	मातृ **Mother** Every mother's care, and every caring act

Even confusion (bhrānti) is her play: nothing is outside the Mother.

NOTES

The Chaṇḍī hymn salutes the Devī who dwells in all beings as consciousness, intelligence, sleep, hunger, power, patience, peace, faith, memory, compassion and mother, and even as delusion. Every faculty we use is her power on loan to us.

Practice: choose one form each day. When you notice it, in hunger, in tiredness or in a moment of patience, say inwardly "namas tasyai", salutations to her. Ordinary moments become places of worship, and the whole day becomes satsang.

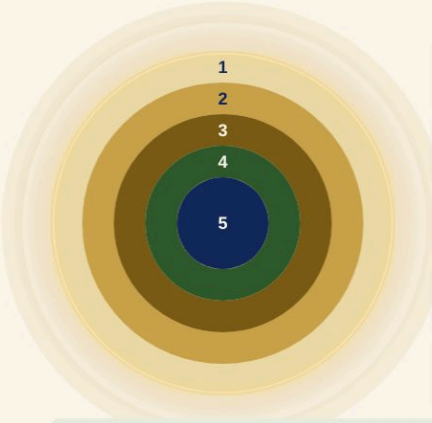
Where you met her today

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

Bring the chant home. Twelve of the forms from the hymn, each with an everyday example. Invite people to recall where they met her today: at breakfast (hunger), last night (sleep), in a moment of patience. The point for newcomers: spirituality is not separate from ordinary life. Every faculty we use is her power on loan. This prepares the next slide, where the same idea is mapped onto the five sheaths.

SHE WITHIN US

Five sheaths, one Power



1	**Ānandamaya** आनन्दमय Bliss	Her subtlest, most pervasive veil: bliss that interpenetrates every other layer.
2	**Vijñānamaya** विज्ञानमय Intellect and ego	She shines as discernment (buddhi) and as the sense of "I" (ahaṁkāra), which can bind or be offered back.
3	**Manomaya** मनोमय Mind and emotions	She moves as feeling, memory and imagination. Even restlessness is her energy, waiting to be turned.
4	**Prāṇamaya** प्राणमय Breath and vitality	She is the breath that breathes us, waking and sleeping, the life-force (prāṇa) that animates the body.
5	**Annamaya** अन्नमय The body	Her most contracted, reduced form: the food that becomes us and the heartbeat we never chose.

NOTES

Beyond and within all five: Parāśakti. We are bubbles in her ocean. The Taittirīya Upaniṣad names five sheaths (kośas). Read from the Mother's side, they are her step-by-step contraction: from pervasive bliss down to the body, her most reduced form.

Each subtler sheath pervades the denser ones, as space pervades a room. Beyond the five is Parāśakti, the cosmic Power one with Consciousness, flowing in and energising every layer. Meditation retraces the path inward: body, breath, mind, intellect, bliss, and into her.

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Five sheaths, one Power

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

Present mode. First click: the field of Parāśakti appears, with ripples flowing inward from all sides, the cosmic Power pouring in and energising. Then each click reveals one sheath from the outside in, following her contraction, as in sūtras 4 and 5 of the Pratyabhijñāhṛdayam. 1, Ānandamaya: subtlest and most pervasive, bliss interpenetrating all. 2, Vijñānamaya: discernment and the sense of I. 3, Manomaya: feeling, memory, imagination. 4, Prāṇamaya: the breath that breathes us. 5, Annamaya: the body, her most contracted form. Final click: Beyond and within all five, Parāśakti. We are all bubbles in that cosmic Consciousness. In meditation we retrace the path: from body to breath, mind, intellect, bliss, and into her. Source: Taittirīya Upaniṣad 2.1 to 2.5 (Brahmānanda Vallī).

SHE WITHIN US

Kuṇḍalinī: the Mother asleep within



1 Śakti asleep
The Mother's power rests coiled at the base of the spine (mūlādhāra): our latent spiritual potential.

2 Śakti rising
Devotion, japa, longing and grace awaken her. As she rises through the centres, awareness rises and widens with her.

3 ***"The rousing of the Kuṇḍalinī is the one and only way to attaining Divine Wisdom."***
Swami Vivekananda, Rāja Yoga

NOTES

Spiritual life is not getting something from outside: it is waking the Mother within. Yoga describes Kuṇḍalinī as Śakti resting coiled at the base of the spine. As she rises through the centres, awareness rises and widens, until she unites with Śiva at the crown.

Sri Ramakrishna described the rising current in vivid images: moving like an ant, a frog, a snake, a bird or a monkey. She awakens safely through purity, devotion and guidance. For most of us the path is simple: japa, prayer, and meditation on the Mother in the heart.

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Kuṇḍalinī: the Mother asleep within

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

The lotuses show the traditional petal counts (4, 6, 10, 12, 16, 2 and the thousand-petalled crown) with each centre's bīja mantra: laṁ, vaṁ, raṁ, yaṁ, haṁ and oṁ. The sahasrāra has no bīja: it is beyond sound, where Śakti merges in Śiva. Emphasise safety: devotion and purity, not forceful techniques.

OUR SPIRITUAL TRADITION

Dakshineswar: a child and his Mother

HIS FIRST VISION

When his longing became unbearable, the temple, the doors, everything vanished. He saw a boundless, shining ocean of Consciousness, its waves rushing towards him, and the Mother's presence filled him.

From the life of Sri Ramakrishna, as he later described it

1. **Longing** — As priest of Mā Bhavatāriṇī, he wept each evening that another day had passed without seeing her.
2. **A child's trust** — He spoke to Mā as a child speaks to its mother: simply, trustingly, depending on her for everything.
3. **Bhajan** — A song of Rāmprasād, so dear to Sri Ramakrishna: [title to be chosen]

NOTES

The ocean he saw is the same Parāśakti in which we are all bubbles. Sri Ramakrishna served as priest of the Kālī temple at Dakshineswar from 1856. His first vision of the Mother came after intense longing, as he later told his disciples.

He related to Mā as a child to its mother, with complete trust and simplicity. The lesson for us is longing: he taught that if we cry for her as a child cries for its mother, she cannot stay away. Devotional songs, like those of Rāmprasād, nourish that longing.

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Dakshineswar: a child and his Mother

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

The vision is given here as a paraphrase of Sri Ramakrishna's own account (in Swami Saradananda's Sri Ramakrishna, the Great Master, and in the Gospel). Link back to the five sheaths: the ocean of Consciousness he saw is Parāśakti, and each of us is a bubble in her.

OUR SPIRITUAL TRADITION

Ṣoḍaśī Pūjā: the Mother in Ma Sarada

यथाग्नेर्दाहिका शक्तिः रामकृष्णे स्थिता हि या ।
सर्वविद्यास्वरूपां तां शारदां प्रणमाम्यहम् ॥

yathāgner dāhikā śaktiḥ rāmakṛṣṇe sthitā hi yā
sarva-vidyā-svarūpāṃ tāṃ śāradāṃ praṇamāmy aham

"As the power to burn abides in fire, she abides in Ramakrishna. To Sarada, the embodiment of all knowledge, I bow."

1872
On the night of Phalahāriṇī Kālī Pūjā, Sri Ramakrishna worshipped Sri Sarada Devi as the Divine Mother, Ṣoḍaśī.

His offering
At the end of the worship he offered at her feet the fruits of all his spiritual practices.

Every woman is Mā
He saw all women as manifestations of the Divine Mother, and taught his disciples to do the same.

Holy Mother: "I am the mother of the wicked, as I am the mother of the virtuous."

NOTES

In 1872, on the night of Phalahāriṇī Kālī Pūjā at Dakshineswar, Sri Ramakrishna worshipped Sri Sarada Devi as Ṣoḍaśī, the Divine Mother. Her praṇām mantra uses his own image: as the power to burn abides in fire, she is the Śakti abiding in him.

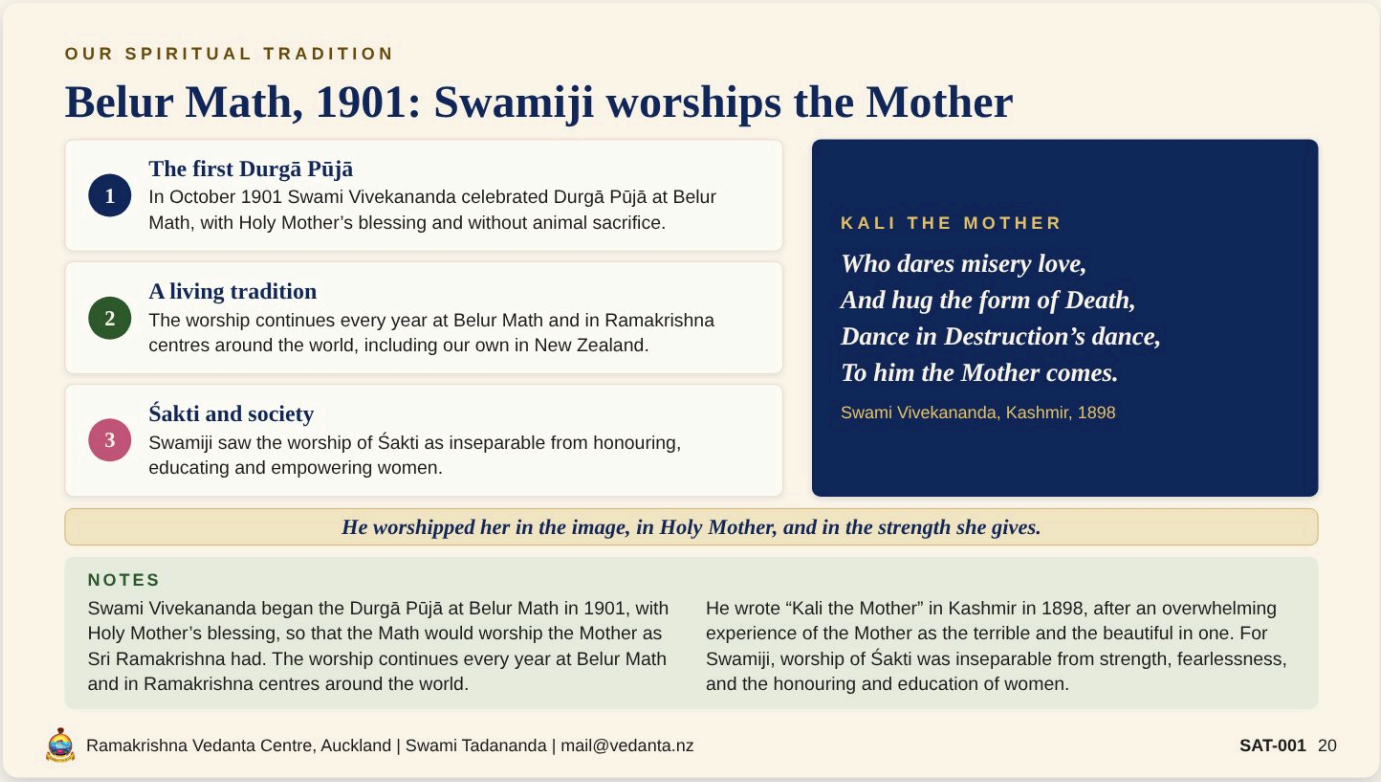
Holy Mother's motherhood embraced everyone: monks and householders, the learned and the simple, saints and sinners. In her the Divine Mother became approachable, practical and kind. Seeing every woman as Mā is a direct practice of this teaching.

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Ṣoḍaśī Pūjā: the Mother in Ma Sarada

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

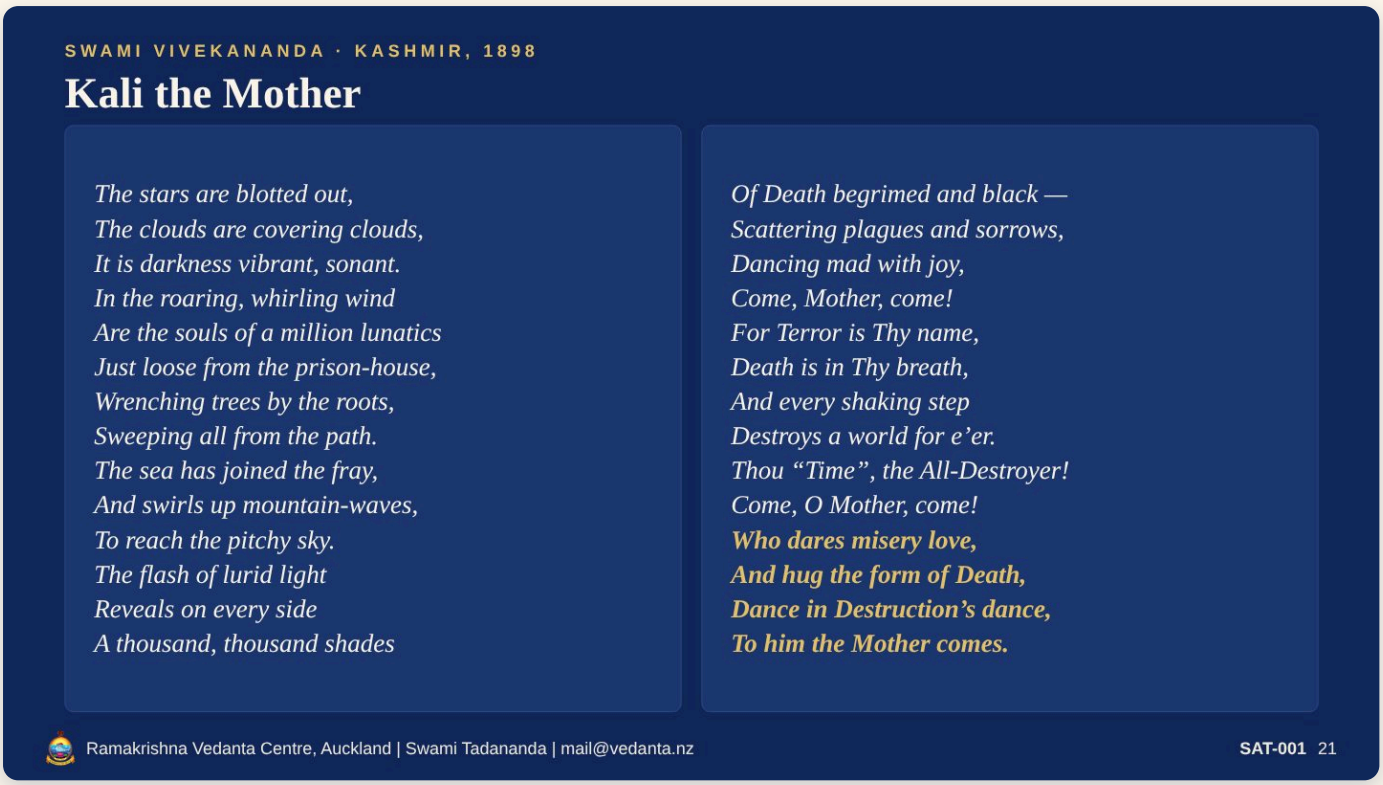
Chant the praṇām mantra together. Note the echo of slide 5: Sri Ramakrishna said Brahman and Śakti are like fire and its power to burn; the mantra says Holy Mother is that power to burn in him. The Ṣoḍaśī Pūjā took place in June 1872 at Dakshineswar, on the night of Phalahāriṇī Kālī Pūjā. Sri Ramakrishna worshipped her as Ṣoḍaśī (Tripurasundarī) and offered his rosary and the fruits of his sādhanā at her feet.



Belur Math, 1901: Swamiji worships the Mother

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

Swami Vivekananda began the Durgā Pūjā at Belur Math in October 1901, with Holy Mother's permission. There was no animal sacrifice. The worship has continued every year since. Our own Durgā Pūjā in New Zealand stands in this line. The closing lines of "Kali the Mother" (Complete Works, Vol. 4) express the fearless love of the Mother that Swamiji embodied. Swamiji repeatedly taught that a nation rises only when its women are honoured and educated; Śakti worship and respect for women were one idea for him.



Kali the Mother

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

"Kali the Mother", written by Swami Vivekananda in Kashmir in 1898 after an overwhelming experience of the Mother, Complete Works, Vol. 4 (poems). Sister Nivedita recounts that he wrote it in a fever of inspiration and fell to the floor exhausted when it was done. Read it slowly, then pause on the last four lines: fearless love of the Mother, accepting the terrible as well as the beautiful, brings her near.



Paths to the Mother

SWAMIJI’S NOTES

Five sādhanas for realising the Mother. Stotra and bhajan: the Chaṇḍī, the Lalitā Sahasranāma, Rāmprasād’s songs. Seeing Mā in all: the practice Sri Ramakrishna taught in the Ṣoḍaśī Pūjā. Meditation: leads to the guided meditation shortly. Surrender: the child’s prayer. Grace: Sri Ramakrishna’s image of the breeze of grace always blowing; we only need to unfurl our sails (paraphrased from the Gospel).

LIVING IT

Her grace in everyday action

> *"If you want peace of mind, do not find fault with others. Rather see your own faults. Learn to make the whole world your own. No one is a stranger, my child; the whole world is your own."*
>
> Holy Mother Sri Sarada Devi, her last message

Morning	During the day	Evening
☐ Offer the day: "Mā, may all I do be your worship"	☐ Before each task: "Mā, you do it through me"	☐ Offer back the day, successes and slips
☐ Salute her in the first breath and the first meal	☐ See her in one person you meet	☐ Thank her for one moment of grace
☐ Bow inwardly to the first person you see	☐ When upset, pause: this too is her energy	☐ Fall asleep resting in her

NOTES

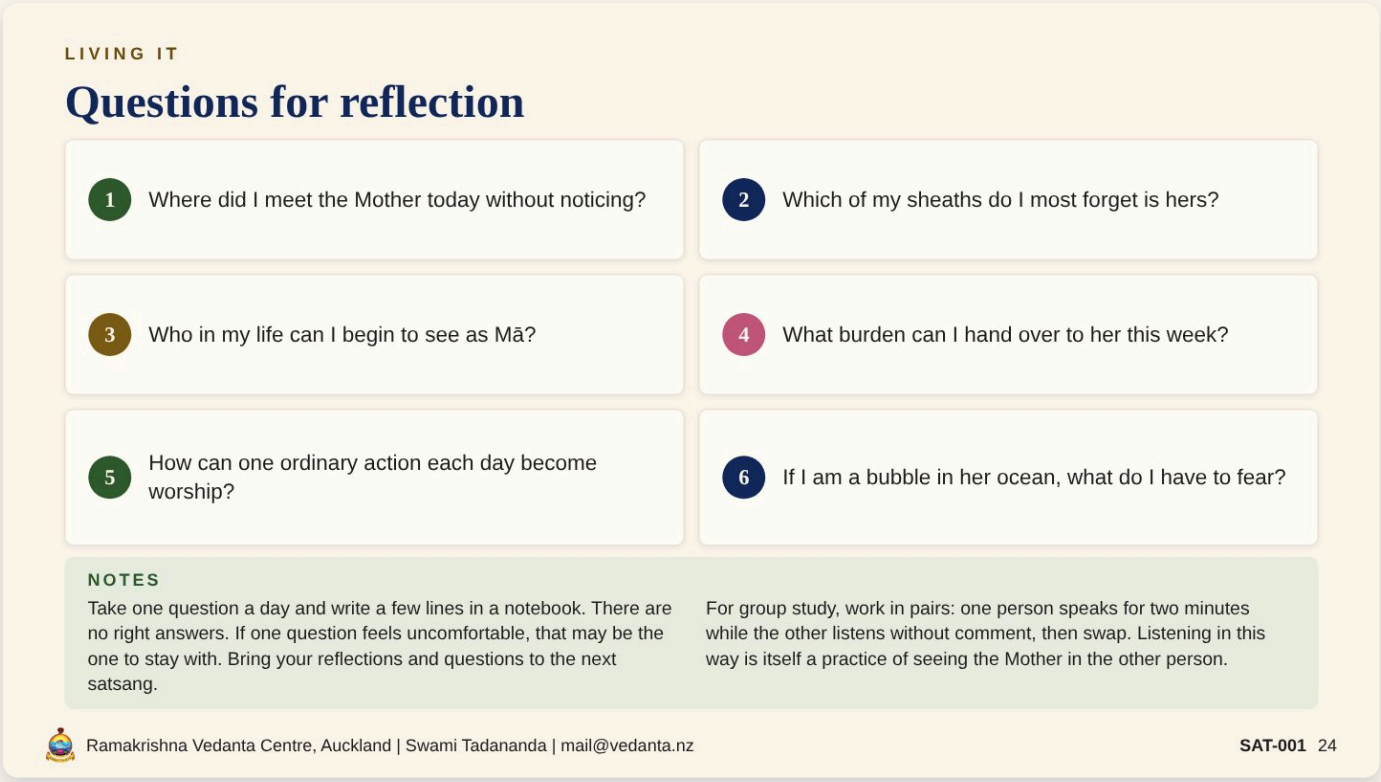
Spiritual practice and everyday work are not two separate worlds. Cooking, driving, emails and caring for family can all be offered to her and done by her power. Holy Mother's last message shows the heart of this: see your own faults, and make the whole world your own.

Use the checklist gently. Begin with two or three items for a week, then add more. A missed day is information, not failure: simply begin again with the morning offering. Over time the offering becomes natural, and the day itself becomes worship.

Her grace in everyday action

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

Holy Mother's last message, given shortly before she passed away in 1920. It is the practical heart of Mother worship: make the whole world your own. The checklist turns the teaching into small daily actions in the spirit of the Hamilton class: morning offering, offering each task, seeing her in one person, pausing when upset, and offering back the day.



Questions for reflection

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

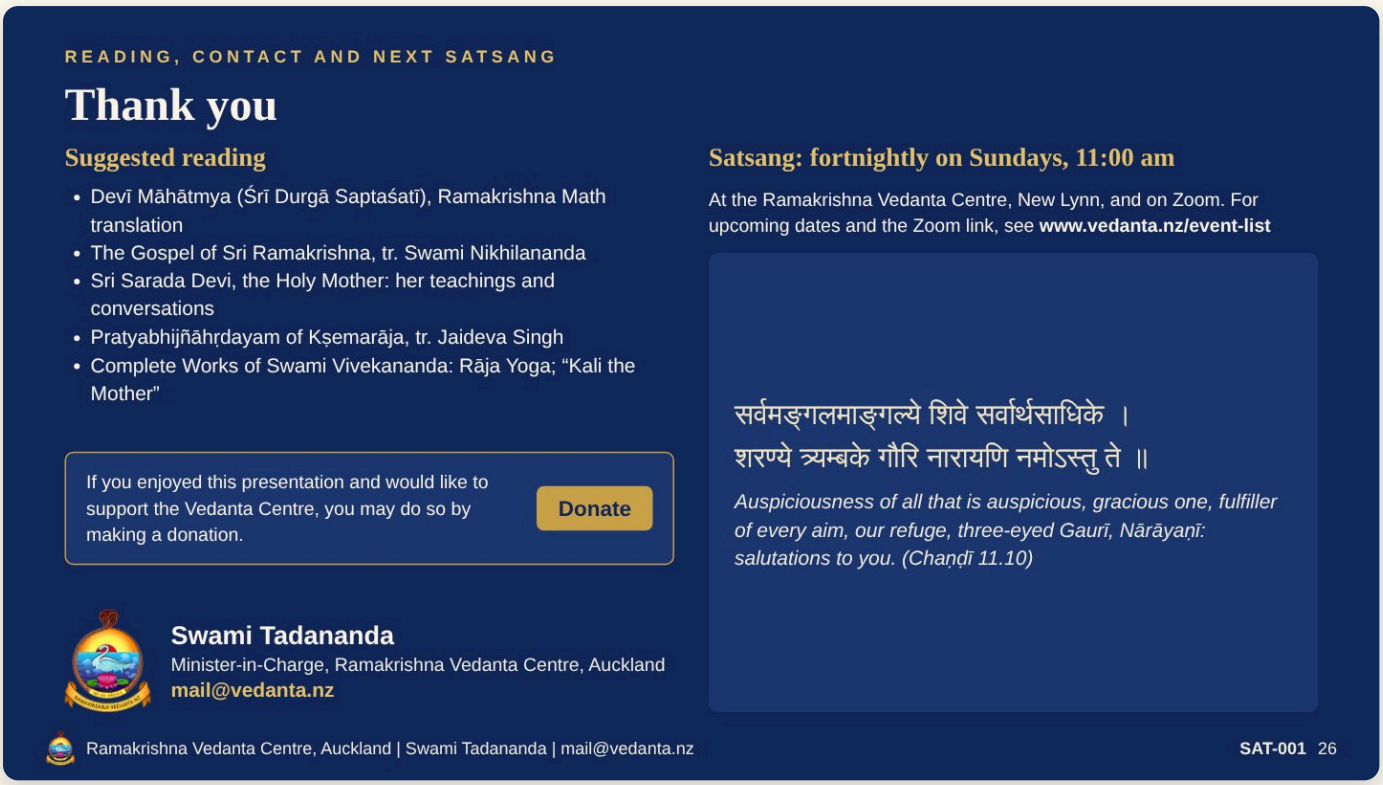
Use this slide to open the questions and answers time, before the guided meditation, or leave it on screen while people reflect. Six questions, from noticing her (1) to the sheaths (2), seeing her in people (3), surrender (4), everyday worship (5), and the fearlessness that comes from knowing we are bubbles in her ocean (6).



Guided meditation: the Mother within

SWAMIJI’S NOTES

Guided meditation, about ten minutes. Suggested words: Sit steady. Let the breath settle. Each breath, she breathes me. Feel the body: this is the Mother in her most contracted form. Now the breath: this too is You, Mā. A feeling, a thought, the sense of I: this too is You. Rest in the heart, where she shines as a soft golden light. Let the light spread beyond the body, into her boundless ocean. Rest there. Offer the meditation for the welfare of all beings. Om śāntiḥ śāntiḥ śāntiḥ.



Thank you

SWAMIJI'S NOTES

Close with the Sarva-maṅgala-māṅgalye verse (Chaṇḍī 11.10) chanted together, then Ārati and prasād. Thank everyone in the room and on Zoom, and invite them to share these slides with friends and family. Mention the Donate button for anyone who wishes to support the Centre: www.vedanta.nz/donate